



PRODUCT & BRAND DESIGN · GOOSE IN A POND

*The **ink** edge*

The design ethos for everything Jarida builds into a pond — the material, the rules, and how work is judged before it reaches a household.

Three documents govern design at Jarida and they do not always agree. This section settles that in advance, so nobody has to relitigate it in a review.

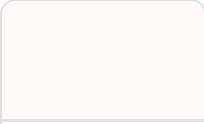
RANK	SOURCE	AUTHORITY
1	The ink edge design-tokens.css and the stylesheets that use it	Always wins. It is the only one of the three currently running in front of a household.
2	Jarida Product & Brand Design Heuristics Aug 2025	Everything the ink edge does not cover: logo, attribution, tone, licensing, the release gate.
3	Designing and Building for Constraints Spotify Design	Method only — how to evaluate. Never overrides a Jarida rule.

Conflicts already resolved

QUESTION	RULING
Charcoal is #1C1C1C in the brand deck and #171616 in the product	#171616 wins — it is what people are looking at. #1C1C1C survives as --grey-900.
Inter, or Quicksand and Comfortaa?	No conflict. The deck says Inter for Google Docs and Slides, Quicksand and Comfortaa <i>in our products</i> . GIAP is a product.
Jarida scores 0–5, Spotify 1–5	Use Jarida's 0–5. Borrow Spotify's language for what the low end means.

When you find a fourth conflict: resolve it in favour of the shipped system, then fix whichever document was wrong in the same change. Leaving the contradiction in place is how the next person loses an afternoon.

Six values carry the identity. Each is listed with its measured contrast against Jarida White, because a colour without its measurement is only a preference.

					
Jarida White #FFF9F9 the ground	Charcoal #171616 17.35:1 · AA	Jarida Purple #8C4BFF 4.42:1 · UI only	Ink #5D23C2 8.12:1 · AA	Slate #566178 5.97:1 · AA	Brand soft #F4ECFF quiet fill

Jarida Purple is not a text colour

It measures **4.42:1** on Jarida White. That clears the 3:1 WCAG asks of a focus indicator or a UI boundary, and misses the 4.5:1 it asks of body copy. So purple is an edge, a ring and an accent — and it is never a sentence. This is not taste; it is the number.

Type

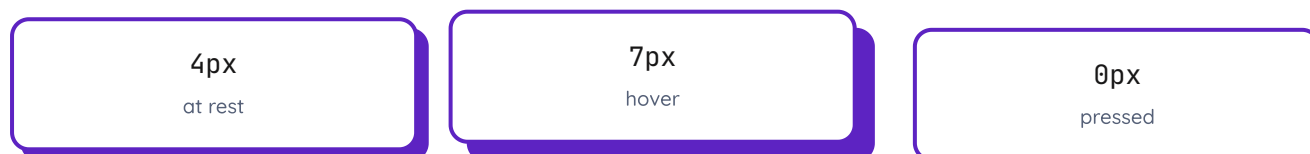
ROLE	FACE	TREATMENT
Display & headings	Quicksand	700, <i>italic</i> , -0.02em tracking
Body	Quicksand	500 / 400
Fallback	Comfortaa	declared in every slot
Data	JetBrains Mono	numbers, paths, measurements, timestamps

Screen titles are set bold italic. That italic is the most recognisable thing about our typography, and it is the reason a settings page reads as something built for a house rather than for a server rack. Use it for titles and leave it alone everywhere else.

Everything we make is paper with a hard purple outline. A card wears a 2px ink border and a hard offset shadow in the same purple — no blur, no spread, no gradient.

State is elevation, not hue

At rest a card floats 4px above its shadow. Hover lifts it to 7px, toward the light. Pressing drives it to 0 — and the card translates by *exactly* the offset it loses, so it lands in the space its own shadow occupied rather than drifting sideways.



That compensating translate is the whole trick. Without it you have a rectangle that got darker; with it you have a key being struck. Nothing else in the system needs to animate.

Spend the offset about twice per screen, and mean it both times. On the voice picker it marks the voice you chose and the button that speaks it — nothing else. Three levels of the same treatment is how a signal stops being one.

The edge marks content, never chrome

Cards carry the edge because they are what the screen is *for*. Toolbars, filters, navigation and section headers stay on a hairline. If the chrome starts shouting, nothing on the page is loud any more — and the loudness was the only thing the edge was buying you.

Nine rules, each with the file that keeps it. Cited so you can read the original argument rather than trust this summary — and so you can tell when the summary has gone stale.

State is elevation, not hue

A chosen thing rises on its offset; the unchosen lie flat with a hairline. Colour never means *selected*.

Spending the page's one real colour on decoration leaves nothing for the control that is actually asking a question.

`voice-picker.css`

Spend the offset twice

Per screen, the hard shadow appears about twice, and both times it carries meaning.

`voice-picker.css`

The edge marks content, never chrome

Cards wear it. Toolbars and navigation do not.

`chat-history.css · models.css`

Press is physical

4px at rest, 7px on hover, 0 pressed, translating by exactly the offset lost.

`chat-history.css — --ink-lift`

Let form carry data

On the conversation wall a card is as tall as its conversation was long — three computed heights, not decorative ones. Shape is a channel most interfaces leave switched off.

`chat-history.css`

Never invent meaning the data lacks

Voices are not colour-coded. They differ by name, accent and grade; assigning each a hue would assert a structure that does not exist, and teach people to read a pattern that is not there.

`voice-picker.css`

Every colour carries its measurement

A token that moved says what it measured and why. Secondary text left slate-400 at 2.6:1; the focus ring left a 45% tint at 2.06:1 for solid accent. The next person inherits the reasoning, not just the hex.

`design-tokens.css`

Touch the chrome, not the data

Visual size and hit size are different things. Navigation grows visually to 44px; dense controls keep a 36px look and reach 44px through an invisible extension — vertically only, because growing sideways makes neighbouring pills steal each other's taps.

`touch.css`

Say what happened, not that something did

Applying a voice reports whether it downloaded, whether the engine reloaded, and which tier is running — because a swap, a half-megabyte fetch and a 326 MB one feel nothing alike. A screen that cannot tell them apart has to either spin or lie.

tts_control.rs

Neither is deprecated. They share tokens, type and the ink edge. What they do not share is how tightly they pack.

HUB

1024×600 and 800×480

A panel on a shelf, driven by a finger, read from across a room.

- Every target clears 44px on its own
- One decision per screen
- Legible at arm's length, and dimmed

CLASSIC

Desktop — keyboard, mouse, and someone who wants all of it at once.

- Density is the entire reason it exists — Logs puts ten filter pills in a row
- Compact visuals, full hit areas underneath
- One hairline, not a phone toolbar

The standing temptation is to inflate the dense view until it matches the touch one. That trade deletes the only reason to keep it. If a control must shrink to fit, shrink the look and keep the target.

Jarida requires low-bandwidth, low-end-device, offline-first thinking. The Spotify toolkit supplies the method, built around Device, Data and Network. A pond is not a phone, so translate before you score.

CONSTRAINT	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
Network	<i>There isn't one, by design.</i> The pond runs local-first and egress is gated. The question is not “does it degrade gracefully offline” but “does it work with the network switched off at all”.
Device	The Jetson Orin Nano is the low-end device: six cores and 8 GB shared between CPU and GPU, with the language model wanting all of it. Every millisecond speech takes is one inference does not get.
Data	Model weights are the data cost. 92 MB, 154 MB and 326 MB are real choices a household pays for once, over a link that may be metered. Show the number before they spend it.
Screen	1024×600 and 800×480, often dim, often viewed from across a room.

Compare under the same constraints, not against your own laptop

The toolkit's warning applies here with force. A voice engine that feels instant on an M-series Mac and stutters on the Orin has not passed — it has only been measured in the wrong place.

What that looks like when done properly:

TIER	THREADS	RTF ON THE ORIN	VERDICT
q8 (old default)	2	1.454	Slower than real time — falls further behind the longer it talks
q4f16 (new default)	4	0.780	Real time, with margin
q8f16	—	—	Returns a full-length buffer of digital silence on this board — and works perfectly on a Mac

None of that is visible from a laptop. The silent tier in particular would have shipped as “working” under any desk-based review. **Measure on the target.**

Accessibility is a floor, not a feature. These come from the Jarida heuristics and are non-negotiable.

- **WCAG 2.1 AA** — 4.5:1 normal text, 3:1 large text and UI indicators. Put the measured ratio in the comment when you pick or change a colour.
- **Keyboard** — everything reachable and operable, with a visible focus state.
- **Screen readers** — semantic HTML; labelled headings, buttons and forms; alt text on every image.
- **Motion** — honour prefers-reduced-motion. The ink lift is the one motion we rely on, and it must be disable-able.
- **Language** — plain, inclusive, gender-neutral; jargon explained and acronyms spelled out on first use.

Two more follow from the hardware: text must stay legible on a **dimmed 800×480 panel**, and important lines must stay visible on a **low-contrast screen** — another reason the ink edge is 2px and not a hairline.

Voice and copy

Friendly, confident, inspiring, inclusive — and, in the original phrasing, *defiant*. Write from the household's side of the screen. Name things by what people control, never by how the system is built.

- Active voice. A control says what happens: “Save changes”, not “Submit”.
- An action keeps its name through the flow. *Publish* produces *Published*.
- Errors say what went wrong and what to do next. They do not apologise and are never vague.
- An empty screen is an invitation to act, not a mood.
- **No emojis in UI or code.** Lucide for function, the logo for brand. A test scans the source — comments included — and fails the build.

Brand and attribution

- Logo in SVG / EPS / PNG. Clear space **1× logo height**. Minimum **24px** digital, **10mm** print.
- Purple on light or neutral grounds; black where purple clashes. Never over a photograph without a 70%-opacity overlay behind it.
- Never stretch, skew, rotate, recolour outside the palette, or add effects.
- Credit **“Jarida Open Source Community”** unless waived; third-party adaptations follow the **Jarida Fair License** attribution clause.

Jarida's scoring methodology, applied to design work. Nothing substandard reaches a household or a stakeholder.

SCORE	MEANING
0	Not addressed, or a critical violation — a showstopper that prevents the task
1	Very poor; does not meet basic requirements
2	Below standard; significant revision needed — real delay, frustration or confusion
3	Meets the minimum, with room to improve — minor effect on usability
4	Meets the standard well; refinements possible
5	Excellent; not an issue

Process

1. **Prepare** — gather the assets, screens and documents under review.
2. **Score independently** — **at least two reviewers**, separately. Don't overthink it: a day or two, then stop.
3. **Meet and resolve** — average the scores and discuss the disagreements, because the disagreements are where the information is.
4. **Decide** — release, revise, or hold.
5. **Document** — the scoring sheet goes in the project repository. Turn the lowest-scoring items into an actual plan.

What to score for a pond surface:

- The nine rules — especially whether the offset was spent more than twice
- The constraint translation — *was this measured on the target?*
- The accessibility floor, with ratios shown
- Copy standards, and the no-emoji guard
- Brand, logo and attribution rules

Paper, one purple line, and the height between them.

The edge marks what the screen is for, and nothing else raises its voice. State is elevation, not hue. Colour is spent once, on the control that is actually asking a question. Every number we show has been measured on the machine it will run on — not on the machine we build from. Nothing encodes a meaning the data does not have, and nothing says a thing happened without saying which thing.

We build for a house on a shelf, on six cores that the language model also wants, on a panel that may be dim and a link that may be metered — and we treat that as the normal case rather than the degraded one.